

The supply-chain team wasn't oversized. Its load sat on managers, with no execution layer beneath them.

Headcount ratios would have called this function efficient. Assessing workload role by role showed a lean structure carrying ~70% more spend per FTE than the peer median, with no planning function and no headroom for the growth it was asked to absorb.

INDUSTRY	ENGAGEMENT CONTEXT	ROLE	DURATION
Energy & utilities — regulated electric & gas	Consulting · US energy utility	Organisational benchmarking & operating model	12 weeks

THE SITUATION

- Leadership needed to know whether the supply-chain organisation could support current spend and planned growth.
- Raw headcount comparisons would obscure real differences in role scope and functional coverage.
- The goal was a fact base for workforce decisions, not a headcount verdict in either direction.

MY CONTRIBUTION

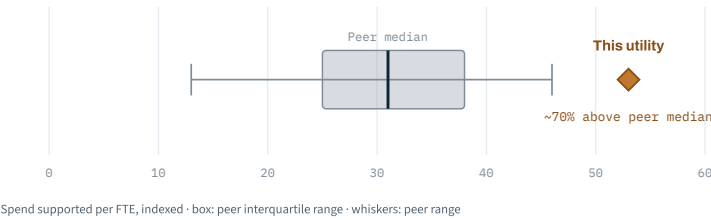
Led the assessment across structure, roles and capacity: defined the peer framework, normalised spend and headcount by workload, clustered roles by capability rather than title, and translated the findings into structural implications.

THE JUDGMENT THAT MATTERED

High spend per person can mean a lean organisation or an overloaded one, and the two call for opposite responses. Reading the number alongside scope and how execution work was distributed turned a benchmark into a recommendation.

EXHIBIT 1 The utility supports more spend per FTE than any peer

Peer distribution, indexed

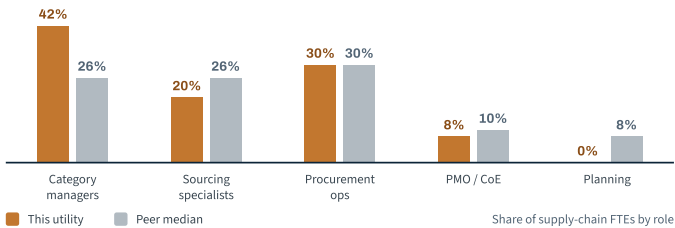


SO WHAT

Beyond the top of the peer range: evidence of a lean, broad-scope structure, not an over-resourced one.

EXHIBIT 2 Capacity is concentrated in manager roles, over a thin execution layer

Illustrative mix, this utility vs peer median



SO WHAT

Managers hold a far larger share of capacity than peers, enablement is thin, and planning has no dedicated FTE: the two structural gaps.

WHAT THE WORK DELIVERED

A structured fact base on supply-chain sizing relative to peers, usable directly in workforce planning.

Two structural gaps identified: lean enablement and no standalone planning function.

A prioritised reinforcement roadmap, de-risked through a single-region pilot with tracked KPIs.

HEADLINE

~70%

more spend per FTE than the peer median — no headroom for growth

Sources. Client function and role-level spend and FTE data, normalised by workload (assets served, spend under management) and clustered by delivered capability rather than job title, benchmarked against comparable regulated utilities. Anonymisation & basis. Client, supplier and peer identities withheld. Outcome figures are rounded from engagement results; exhibit internals are indexed or illustrative and show the analytical structure, not client data.